BACSE202 · Fall Semester 2026

PolyVote

A Multi-Tenant, Ranked-Choice Election Platform with a Tamper-Evident Audit Trail

Review 3 · Final Project Review · Guide: Dr. Katari Balakrishna



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REVIEW 3 · WHERE WE STAND

What we submitted, what we built, what is new today

SUBMITTED

Reviews 1 and 2

Design, schema, ER and data-flow diagrams, literature; then a working React + FastAPI system, instant-runoff tally, hash-chained receipts and a live tamper test.

FEEDBACK

At Review 2

Confirm the voter with a second factor (OTP or face ID); finish MongoDB and hosting; show that the design is an improvement, not just a build.

NEW TODAY

This review

Atlas ledger, keyed chain, extended sweep, emailed one-time code, public link and QR, and 47 executable test scenarios with benchmarks.

~85%

of the planned scope

Up from 75% at Review 2. This is our own estimate. Still open by choice: Oracle with PL/SQL and roles, the POSITION entity, and a true cloud platform.

Today: recap, new features, evidence, comparison, limits, publication plan.

PICKING UP FROM REVIEW 2

Review 2 left a short list; two new features lead it

REVIEW 2 ENDED WITH

- About 75% of the scope built and demonstrated.
- Open: MongoDB Atlas, hosting, injected-ballot detection.
- Faculty feedback: confirm the voter with a second factor.
- Deferred on purpose: Oracle with PL/SQL, POSITION entity.

NEW: EMAIL OTP

A correct password is no longer enough.

A 6-digit code is emailed to the voter, valid 5 minutes, one use, 3 guesses.

Answers the Review 2 comment.

NEW: QR VOTING

Scan, sign in, vote.

The vote page shows a QR code for the public link, so any phone opens the ballot in seconds.

Works with the emailed code on the same phone.

RESPONSE TO FEEDBACK

Each Review 2 comment has a concrete answer

Comment at Review 2	What we did	Evidence
Confirm the voter: OTP or face ID	Emailed one-time code after the password; separate verification database; admin outbox	14 of 14 OTP tests pass
Finish MongoDB	Ledger now in MongoDB Atlas, unique-index concurrency control, file fallback, migration script	25 blocks migrated; live health endpoint
Host it online	Public HTTPS link through a tunnel; QR code on the voter page for phones	Cast a ballot from a phone
Prove it is better	47-scenario executable suite run on the Review 2 design and the final design	6 of 13 to 12 of 13 attacks caught
Weak spots we knew about	Injected ballots, forged receipts, rewritten chains, renamed candidates	Each has a test and a fix

Where we say "future work", it is because the design needs something we cannot add honestly in one semester, and we say what.

WHAT CHANGED SINCE REVIEW 2

Six changes, each tied to a weakness we could measure

1

Ledger in MongoDB Atlas

Unique block index, file fallback, migration script, health endpoint

2

Keyed hash chain

Blocks sealed with HMAC-SHA-256 under an external key

3

Sealed candidate roster

Each block carries a hash of the candidate list

4

Extended integrity sweep

Injected ballots, roster change, flag/ballot/receipt mismatch

5

Email one-time code

Standalone module, own database, hashed single-use codes

6

Public link + QR + tests

Tunnel hosting, scan-to-vote, 47 executable scenarios

Everything else from Review 2 (schema, trigger, tally engine, admin console, DB Studio) is unchanged and still passes.

PROJECT STATUS

About 85% done; the open items are the ones we deferred

Item	Review 2	Now
Multi-tenant normalised schema	Done	Done
Complex queries, views, trigger	Done	Done
Application integration (React + FastAPI)	Done	Done
Polyglot persistence (document store)	Partly	Done: MongoDB Atlas
Tamper detection	Done	Done: extended and keyed
Voter second factor	Suggested	Done: email one-time code
Comparative study and evaluation	Not started	Done: 47 scenarios
Live deployment	Not started	Partly: public link, not a cloud platform
DCL roles and PL/SQL procedures (Oracle)	Planned	Not started
POSITION entity	Deferred	Not started

THREAT MODEL

Who the attacker is, and who we do not stop

ID	Adversary	Capability	PolyVote response	Status
A1	Voter with a leaked or guessed password	Signs in as someone else	Emailed one-time code; one-vote trigger	Prevented
A2	Network observer	Reads or alters traffic	Out of scope beyond TLS at the tunnel	Not covered
A3	Rogue database administrator	Read/write on the election database only	Integrity sweep: modified, deleted, injected, mismatch	Detected
A4	Ledger-store administrator	Read/write on the ledger store only	HMAC hash chain; unique block index	Detected
A5	Insider with both stores, no secrets	Edits both stores to match each other	Keyed chain + sweep catch forged receipts, rewrites	Detected
A6	Insider with both stores and the ledger key	Forges valid blocks	Needs external anchoring (future work)	Not covered
A7	Roster injection through the admin path	Adds a ghost voter, votes as them through the API	Needs a committed roster (future work)	Not covered

Detected means found by an auditor running the checks, not blocked in real time.

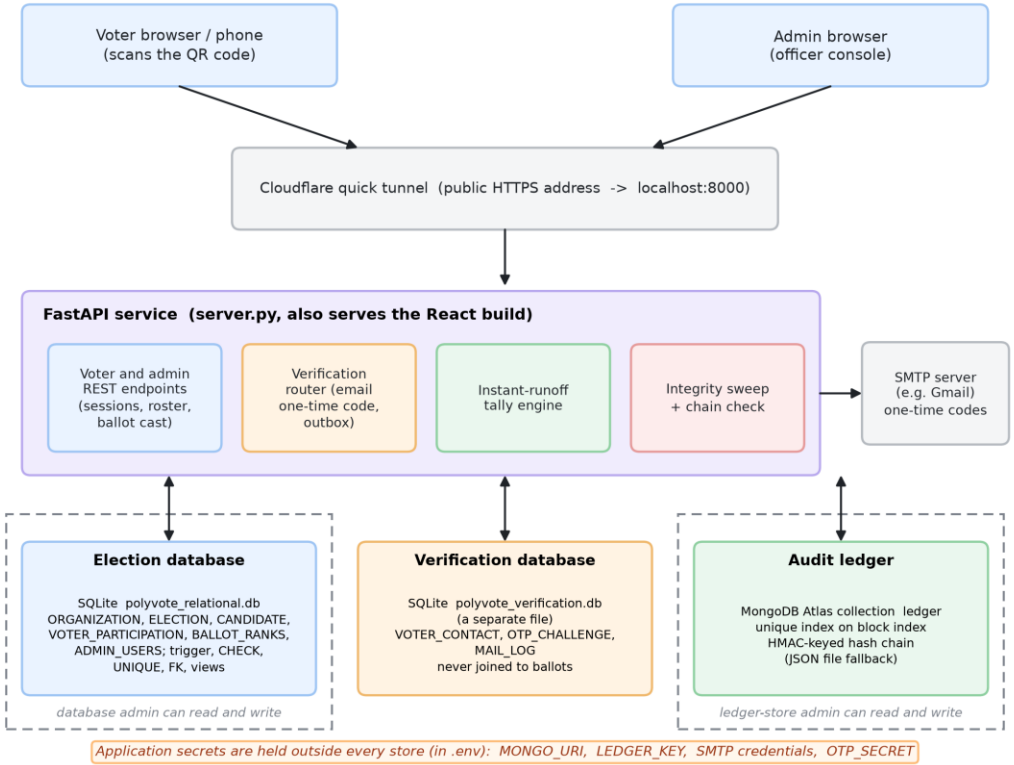
SECURITY GOALS

Eight goals, each with a mechanism we can test

Goal	Statement	Mechanism
G1	No voter can vote twice	Trigger, CHECK, unique roster, single-use session, write lock
G2	Only rostered, verified voters vote	Roster lookup, password, emailed code
G3	Ballots are anonymous in storage	No linking column; random ballot tokens
G4	Malformed ballots are rejected	CHECK, composite key, foreign key, API validation
G5	Edits, deletions, insertions are detectable	Per-ballot receipt and integrity sweep
G6	Ledger cannot be silently rewritten without the key	HMAC chain, unique index, separate store
G7	Candidate attribution is fixed after voting	Roster hash sealed in every block
G8	A voter can confirm their ballot is counted	Receipt token and public receipt check

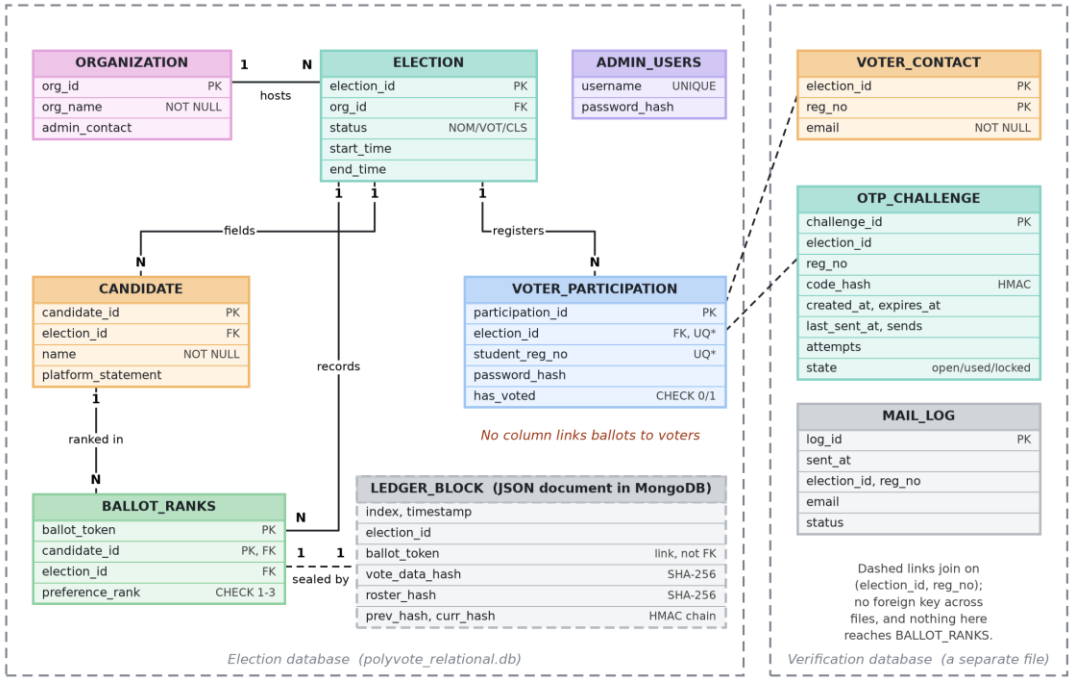
FINAL ARCHITECTURE

Three stores, separated by what each is trusted with



- **Election DB:** roster, candidates, anonymous ballots.
- **Verification DB:** emails and one-time codes, a separate file, never joined to ballots.
- **Ledger:** MongoDB Atlas, HMAC chain.
- **Secrets:** in .env, outside every store.
- **An administrator of one store cannot touch the others.**

Data model: election, ledger and verification stores

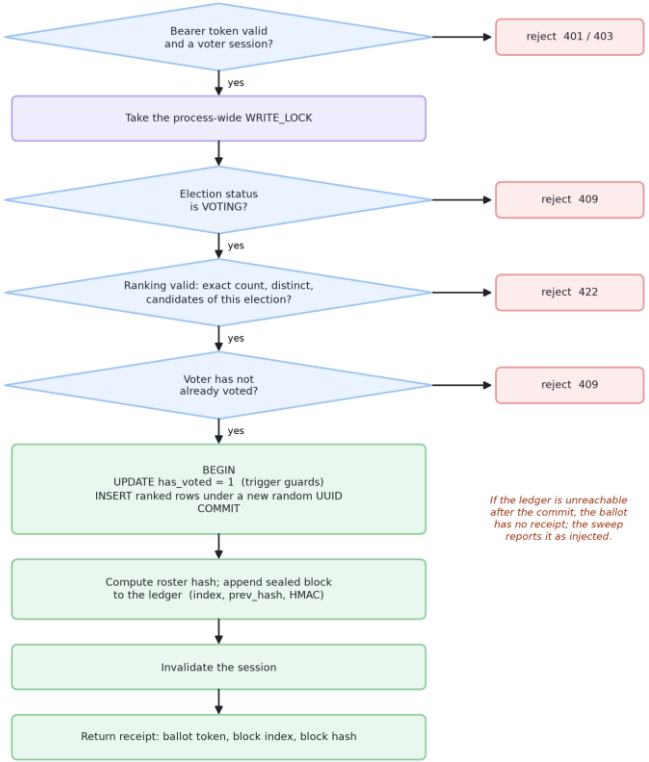


Solid line: foreign key. Dashed: logical link to another store (not an FK). PK primary key, FK foreign key, UQ unique, CHECK check rule.
* UNIQUE (reg_no, election_id). A trigger blocks marking a voter as voted twice.

- Shared multi-tenant schema, scoped by election.
- No column links a ballot to a voter.
- Candidate roster hash sealed in the ledger.
- Emails live in a different file; no key reaches ballots.
- Trigger, CHECK, UNIQUE, FK enforce the rules.

CASTING A BALLOT

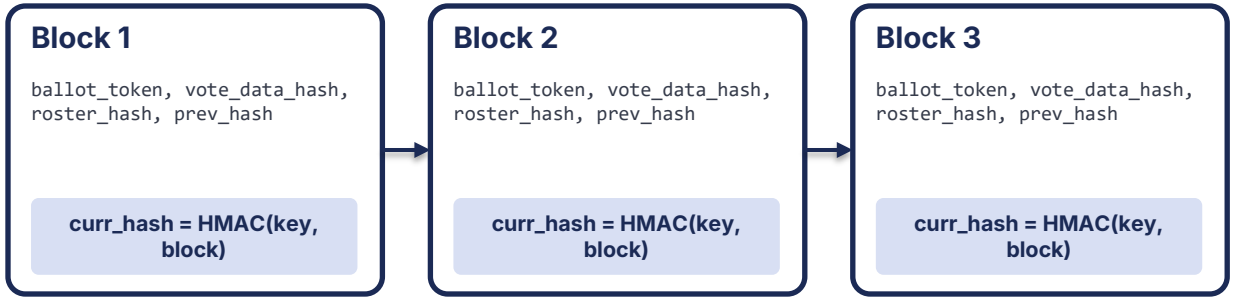
One serialised, transactional path touches every structure



- **Serialised:** a write lock plus the voted flag, checked inside the transaction.
- **Atomic:** flag and ballot rows commit together or not at all.
- **Anonymous:** the ballot is stored under a random token.
- **Sealed:** then a block with the ranks hash and roster hash joins the ledger.
- **Fails visibly:** if the ledger is down after commit, the sweep reports a ballot with no receipt.

KEYED AUDIT LEDGER

Keyed chain: rebuilding it needs the secret key



`prev_hash` links each block to the one before it.

- **Review 2:** curr_hash was plain SHA-256. An attacker who can write the store can edit a ballot and recompute every later hash.
- **Final:** curr_hash is HMAC-SHA-256 under LEDGER_KEY, held outside the database and the ledger store. Without the key the rebuilt chain fails verification.
- **Roster hash:** every block also seals the candidate list, so renaming candidates after voting is detected.
- **Backward compatible:** blocks written before the key existed still verify (LEDGER_LEGACY_UNTIL).
- **Limit:** whoever holds the key can still forge blocks; that needs an external witness (future work).

INTEGRITY SWEEP

Five rules compare the database with the ledger

Rule	Detects	How	New?
1 Modified	A ballot whose ranks changed	Recompute ranks hash; compare with the receipt	Review 2
2 Deleted	A sealed ballot missing from the database	Receipt exists with no ballot rows	Review 2
3 Injected	A ballot with no receipt	Ballot rows exist with no block	New
4 Roster changed	Candidate names altered after voting	Current roster hash differs from the sealed hash	New
5 Count mismatch	Flags, ballots, receipts disagree	Compare the three counts for the election	New

Plus the chain check: recompute every block's link and hash across the whole ledger. The chain check finds edits inside the ledger; the sweep finds edits to the database.

MONGODB ATLAS LEDGER

A real document store with its own concurrency control

- **Collection:** each block is one document in polyvote.ledger.
- **Unique index on block index:** two writers cannot both claim the next slot, so the chain cannot fork.
- **Append cost:** reads only the last block and inserts one document, so it does not grow with the chain.
- **Fallback:** no connection string, or Atlas unreachable, and it uses the local file; /api/health shows which.
- **Migration:** a script copies the old blocks and verifies the chain; it refuses to overwrite a non-empty collection.
- **Secrets:** the connection string lives in .env, never in the code or the repository.

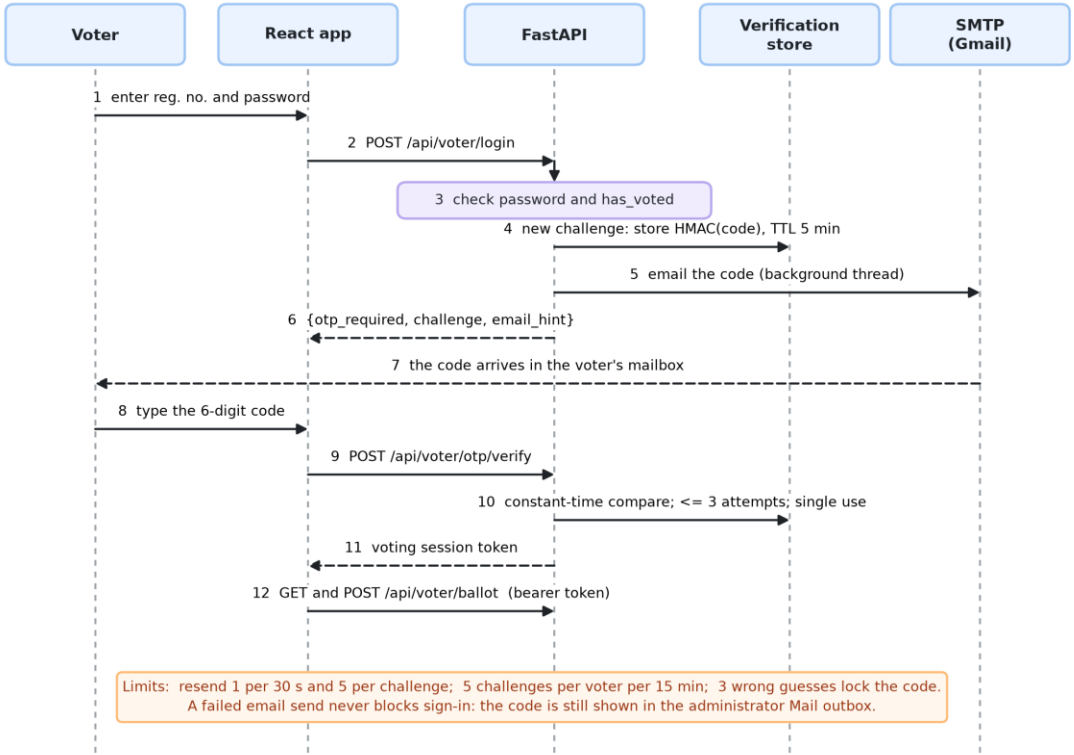
Live health check

```
{"backend":"mongodb",
 "detail":"mongodb
   (polyvote.ledger)",
 "sealing":"hmac-sha256"}
```

Editing any block in Atlas (for example a vote_data_hash) makes the Audit ledger page show "Data tampered at block N".

EMAIL ONE-TIME CODE

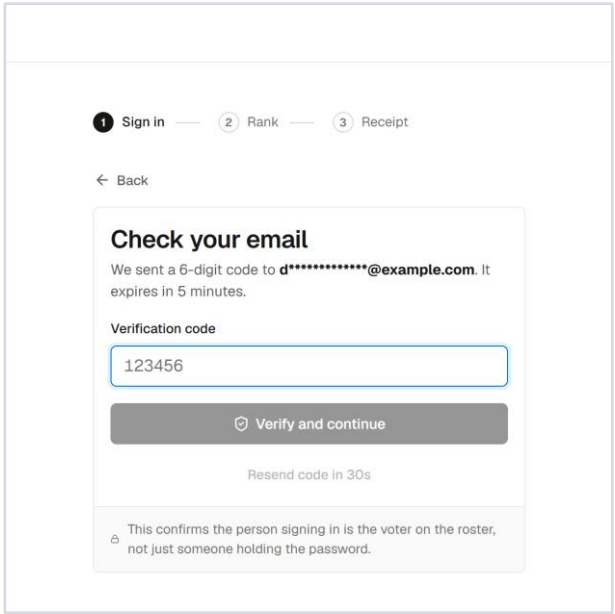
A correct password no longer opens a ballot on its own



EMAIL ONE-TIME CODE · DESIGN

Small choices that make it hold up

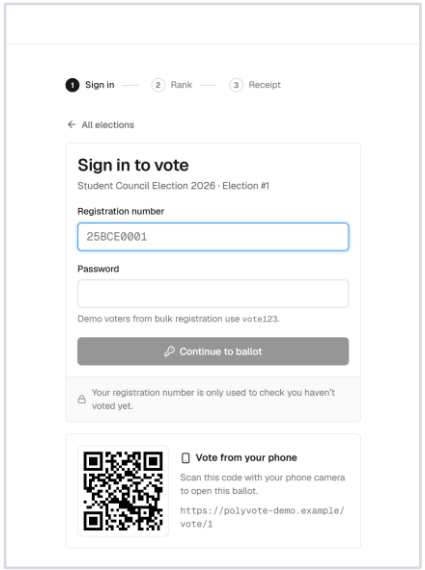
Choice	Value
Code	6 digits from a secure generator
Stored as	HMAC of challenge and code
Valid for	5 minutes, single use
Guesses	3 per code, then locked
Resend	1 per 30 s, 5 per challenge
Challenges	5 per voter per 15 min
Delivery	SMTP; failure never blocks sign-in
Where emails live	Separate database



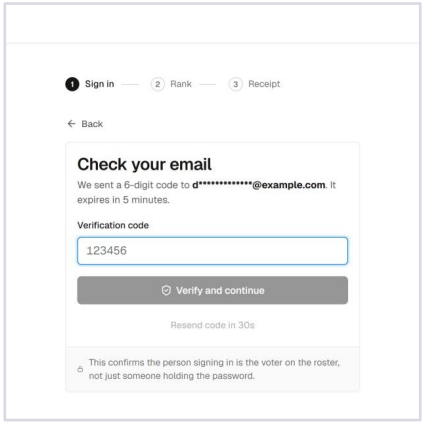
The voter sees only a masked address.

THE VOTER EXPERIENCE

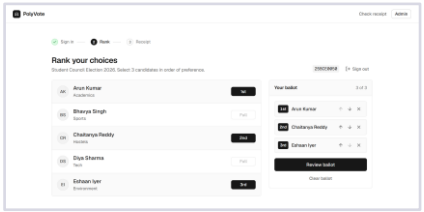
Sign in, confirm by code, rank, and keep a receipt



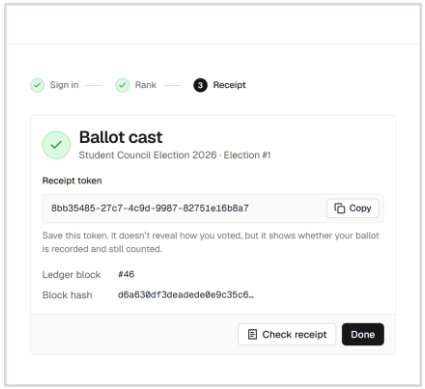
1 Sign in (QR for phones)



2 Enter the emailed code

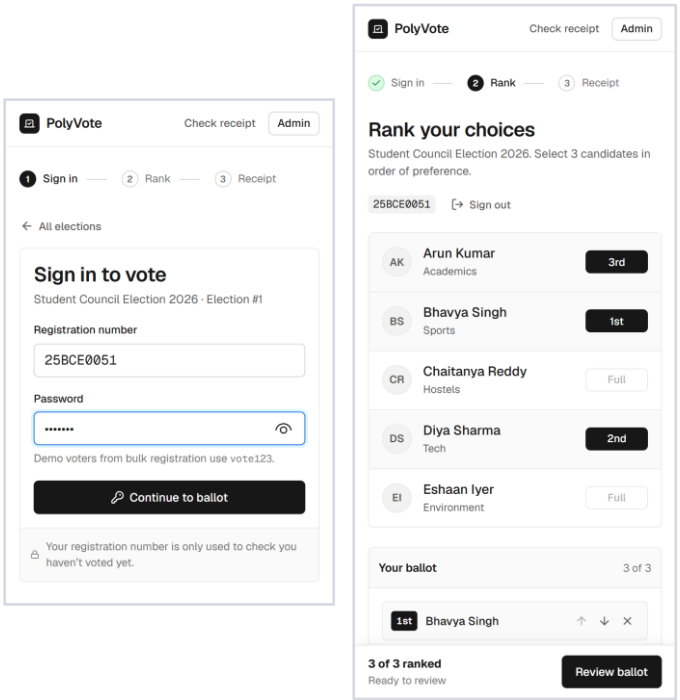


3 Rank three choices



4 Receipt token

Phone voting, a public link, and an honest account



- **How:** a Cloudflare quick tunnel gives a temporary public HTTPS address; the vote page shows a QR code for it.
- **Works from any network;** tested casting a real ballot from a phone.
- **What it is not:** cloud deployment. The laptop must stay on, and the address changes when the tunnel restarts.
- **Why we say so:** a true cloud platform with Oracle is the next step.
- **Safe by default:** secrets stay in .env; the repository holds only .env.example.

LIVE DEMO · SAMPLE POLYVOTE

The same system with email verification switched on

1

Admin

Voters have emails; Mail outbox open

2

Sign in

Password right, still no ballot

3

Code

Read it from the outbox or inbox

4

Vote

Rank, cast, get the receipt

5

Seal

Receipt check; new block in Atlas

6

Tamper

DB Studio edit; sweep names it

7

Ledger

Edit a block in Atlas; chain breaks

Safety net

Every code also appears in the outbox, so a slow email cannot stall the demo.

Separate copy: its own database, its own Atlas collection, port 8001; START_DEMO resets it in about 20 seconds.

HOW WE EVALUATED

47 executable scenarios, old design versus final

7	13	13	14	3
DB prevention	**API abuse**	**Tampering**	**One-time code**	**Benchmark sizes**
Statements the schema should reject	Wrong password, injection, replay, races	Edits by someone with storage access	Replay, expiry, limits, failure	100, 1,000, 10,000 ballots

- A throwaway copy of the app is driven through the real API; a "rogue administrator" edits the database and ledger files directly.
- Baseline: the Review 2 design, checked out and run unchanged. Attacker scripts never receive the ledger key.
- Outcome per attack: detected by the sweep or chain, visible only in counters, or not detected. Benchmarks are medians of three runs.

PREVENTION RESULTS

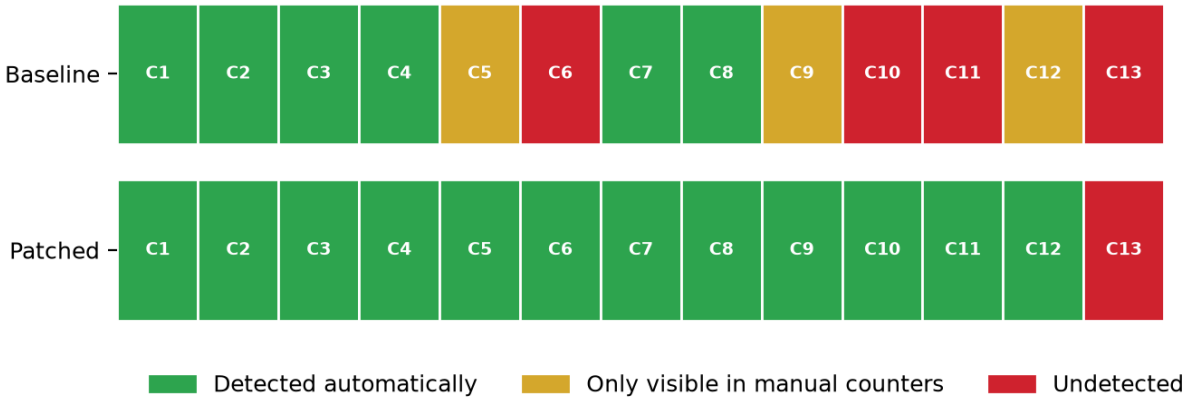
Prevention results: one gap taught us something

Attempt	Stopped by	Result
Second vote by the same voter	Trigger	Prevented
Rank 4 on a 1–3 ballot	CHECK	Prevented
Same candidate ranked twice	Composite key	Prevented
Duplicate roster entry	UNIQUE	Prevented
Wrong password, SQL injection, replayed session	API	Prevented
20 simultaneous casts by one voter	Lock + transaction	Exactly one accepted
Nonexistent candidate from a default console	FK (off by default in SQLite)	Not prevented

The gap: SQLite enforces foreign keys only on connections that enable it. The application does; a console with default settings does not. A server database removes this, which is part of the Oracle move.

TAMPERING RESULTS

Automatic detection rises from 6 of 13 to 12 of 13



6/13

Review 2 design: detected automatically

12/13

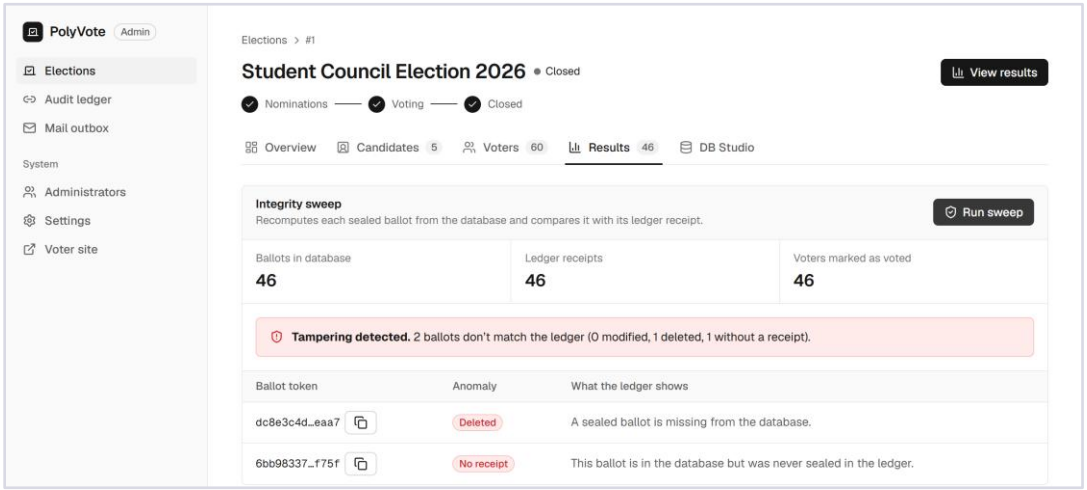
Final design: detected automatically

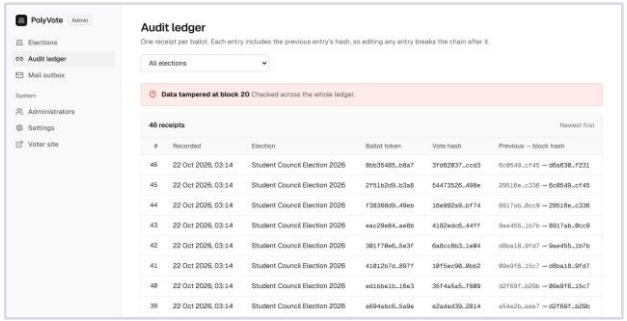
1

Still undetected: roster injection (C13)

SWEEP IN ACTION

A deletion and an injection hide in the counts





- **Left: counters read 46 / 46 / 46, yet the sweep reports 1 deleted and 1 without a receipt.**
- **Above: one edited block breaks the chain.**

WHY THE KEY MATTERS

Six scenarios the Review 2 design missed

ID	Scenario	Review 2	Final	What closed it
C5	Inject a ballot with no receipt	Counters only	Detected	Injected-ballot rule
C6	Ballot stuffing: inject, forge receipt, set a flag	Not detected	Detected	Keyed chain
C9	Truncate the last ledger block	Counters only	Detected	Reconciliation rule
C10	Alter a ballot and rebuild the whole chain	Not detected	Detected	Keyed chain
C11	Swap two candidates' names after voting	Not detected	Detected	Sealed roster hash
C12	Reset a voted flag, vote again	Counters only	Detected	Reconciliation rule

Key point: C6 and C10 defeat any chain that is only hashed, because the attacker recomputes the hashes. With the HMAC key they fail at the first block the attacker cannot compute.

ONE-TIME CODE TESTS

14 of 14 pass, and the suite caught a real defect on the way

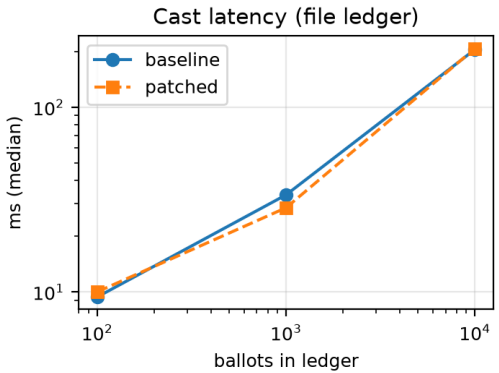
- Password alone gives no session; the challenge id is not a token.
- Right code opens the ballot; a used code cannot be replayed.
- Three wrong codes lock the challenge, even if the right code follows.
- Expired codes, rapid resends and a sixth code are refused.
- No email on file: clear refusal.
- Plaintext codes are absent from the database.
- A failed mail server does not block sign-in.
- No email column exists in the election database.

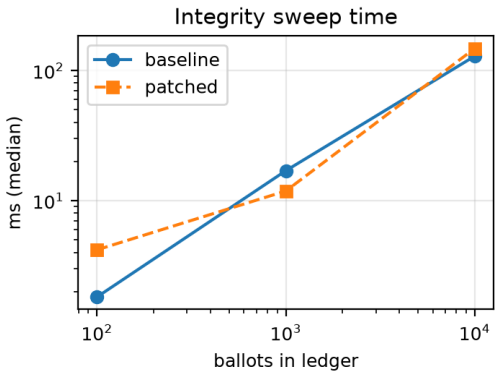
The defect

Test F4 first failed. The wrong-guess counter was saved inside a database context, and the request then raised an error. SQLite rolls back when an exception leaves the context, so every failed guess was recorded and then undone: unlimited guessing. The fix commits state before the error propagates. Review would not have found it; the test did.

PERFORMANCE

Checks are cheap; the file ledger is the one that grows





- Sweep at 10,000 ballots: 147 ms, about 15% slower than before.
- File ledger: a cast grows from 9 to 205 ms because each append rewrites the file.
- Atlas: about 147 ms at any size (network round trip).
- The file is faster when small; Atlas wins on flat growth, concurrency control and living off-machine.

Ballots	Cast ms (file)	Sweep ms	Atlas append ms
100	9	4	136
1,000	33	12	147
10,000	205	147	139

COMPARISON WITH EXISTING SYSTEMS

Different design points, different guarantees

System	Main assurance	Voter verifies	Burden
Helios, Belenios	Encrypted ballots; publicly verifiable tally	Yes (recorded as cast)	Moderate
Civitas, Prêt à Voter, Scantegrity II	Verifiable; some coercion-resistant	Yes	High
Estonian i-voting	National cryptographic system; analysed weaknesses	Partial	High
Commercial mobile or web voting	Vendor trust; analyses found vulnerabilities	No	Low
PolyVote	Database rules; keyed audit ledger; reconciling sweep	Recorded and counted, not content	Low

Based on the published designs; we did not run these systems. PolyVote is not a substitute where a hostile administrator is the main concern; it targets elections where cryptographic voting is impractical.

COMPARATIVE STUDY · SCOPE

We compared PolyVote with five kinds of similar systems

Cryptographic

Helios, Belenios, Civitas

Encrypted, publicly verifiable tallies

Commercial SaaS

ElectionBuddy, OpaVote, Simply Voting

Hosted elections, vendor trust

General forms

Google Forms, Microsoft Forms

Quick polls, owner can edit results

Typical student apps

CRUD voting projects

One table, one password, no audit

National systems

Estonian i-voting

ID-card based, large infrastructure

How

Published designs and vendor pages, ten properties, and our own executable tests for PolyVote. We did not run the other systems.

The question is not "who has the strongest cryptography" but "which system makes a small election both easy to run and hard to tamper with undetected".

COMPARATIVE STUDY · FEATURES

Where PolyVote stands on ten properties

Property	Student app	Forms tools	Commercial SaaS	Helios / Belenios	PolyVote
Ranked-choice (instant-runoff) built in	No	No	Advertised	Varies	Yes
Many organisations on one install	No	No	Yes	Partly	Yes
One-vote rule enforced inside the database	Rare	No	Not documented	n/a (crypto)	Yes
Voter and ballot stored with no linking column	Rare	No	Not documented	Yes	Yes
Tamper detection with published test evidence	No	No	Vendor logs	Yes	Yes (47 tests)
Second factor at sign-in	Rare	Account login	Often email links	Credential email	Emailed OTP
Scan-to-vote on a phone	No	No	Varies	No	Yes
Voter verifies own ballot content	No	No	Varies	Yes	Recorded, counted
Open source, one-command run	Often	No	No	Yes	Yes
Cost to run a small election	Free	Free	Paid per voter	Free, ops-heavy	Free

Entries for other systems come from their published designs and vendor pages, not our testing; "Varies" and "Not documented" mean we could not confirm. PolyVote's column is backed by the tests in this deck.

COMPARATIVE STUDY · WHAT IS UNIQUE

Five things we found together nowhere else

1	**Integrity inside the database**	Trigger, CHECK, unique and foreign keys refuse bad votes before any application code runs.
2	**Keyed ledger in a separate store**	HMAC chain in MongoDB Atlas with a sealed candidate roster: rebuilding it needs a key.
3	**Three separate stores**	Ballots, voter emails and the ledger never share a database or a join.
4	**OTP plus QR on any phone**	Emailed code with strict limits, and a QR code that opens the ballot.
5	**Evidence, not claims**	An executable suite attacks the old and the final design; automatic detection rose from 6 to 12 of 13.

COMPARATIVE STUDY · VERDICT

Best for small elections, not a Helios replacement

PolyVote IS THE BETTER FIT WHEN

- A club, council or class needs ranked-choice results.
- Someone must be able to run it in an afternoon, free.
- You need proof that edits and deletions are caught.
- Voters should confirm themselves by email and vote from a phone.

CHOOSE HELIOS / BELENIOS WHEN

- The administrator itself cannot be trusted.
- Voters must verify their own ballot content.
- Coercion or vote selling is a real threat.
- A public cryptographic audit is required.

Our claim: for the elections it targets, PolyVote is simpler to run, enforces more inside the database, and is the only one here with tested evidence.

REVIEW 2 DESIGN VERSUS FINAL DESIGN

What improved, measured

Measure	Review 2	Final
Tampering detected automatically	6 of 13	12 of 13
Forged receipt or chain rewrite	Undetected	Detected (key)
Candidate renaming	Undetected	Detected (sealed roster)
Voter authentication	Password	Password + emailed code
Ledger storage	Local file	MongoDB Atlas
Ledger append at 10,000 ballots	205 ms (file, whole cast)	~147 ms (Atlas, flat)
Sweep at 10,000 ballots	129 ms	147 ms
Access	Local only	Public link + QR

LIMITATIONS AND FUTURE WORK

What we do not claim, and what comes next

Limitation	Direction
Insider with key and both stores can forge (A6)	Publish the chain head to an external witness; managed secret store
Roster injection is not detected (A7)	Committed or signed roster, checked at sweep time
Not end-to-end verifiable; receipt shows recorded, not content	Cast-as-intended mechanism, or a verifiable protocol if needed
Passwords stored as plain SHA-256; default admin login	Salted, slow hashing; forced first-login change
Email is a weak second factor	Authenticator app (TOTP) or printed one-time slip
IRV ties broken arbitrarily; no statistical audit	Published tie rule; risk-limiting audit
SQLite foreign keys are per connection; single node	Oracle or PostgreSQL with PL/SQL, roles; cloud platform

OPEN FOR SUBMISSION TODAY · BY FEE

Venues still accepting papers, cheapest first

#	Venue	Submit by	Student fee	Where	IEEE/Springer indexing	Fit
1	Confluence 2027	4 Dec 2026	INR 8,000 + GST	Noida, India	Submitted for IEEE Xplore	Good
2	INDIACom-2027	7 Dec 2026	INR 8,000 + GST	New Delhi, India	IEEE approval pending	Good
3	IEM-ICDC 2027	10 Dec 2026	INR 8,000	Kolkata, India	Springer awaited; 10+ pages	Stretch
4	ICRCICN 2027	30 Nov 2026	INR 8,500	Kalyani, India (hybrid)	IEEE record 73691; conditional	Stretch
5	ICESICSC-2027	30 Oct 2026	INR 9,000	Bhubaneswar, India	Says published by IEEE	Good
6	i-PACT 2027 (VIT)	31 May 2027	INR 12,000	Vellore, India	Recommended to IEEE	Stretch
7	ISDFS 2027	31 Jan 2027	USD 500 (~INR 47,000)	San Jose, USA (online ok)	Submitted for IEEE Xplore	Stretch
8	ICISSP 2027	29 Oct 2026	EUR 640 (~INR 68,000)	Valletta, Malta	Submitted for evaluation	Good
9	DATA 2027	16 Feb / 25 Mar	EUR 640 (~INR 68,000)	Rome, Italy	Not confirmed	Good
10	ICEIS 2027	17 Nov / 21 Dec	EUR 680 (~INR 72,000)	Rome, Italy	Submitted for evaluation	Good

Fees are per accepted paper and excluding travel, GST and bank charges; INR is approximate at 22 Oct 2026 rates. No venue has yet confirmed indexing; "submitted for" is a plan, not a result.

OPEN FOR SUBMISSION TODAY · BY LOCATION

India first, then online-capable, then abroad

INDIA

- **Noida:** Confluence, 4 Dec
- **New Delhi:** INDIACom, 7 Dec; ICICC, 30 Oct
- **Kolkata and Kalyani:** IEM-ICDC, 10 Dec; ICRCICN, 30 Nov
- **Bhubaneswar:** ICESICSC, 30 Oct (7 days left)
- **Vellore:** i-PACT, 31 May 2027
- **Also:** Asansol, Chennai, Goa, Salem (fees not verified)

ONLINE-CAPABLE

- **ISDFS 2027:** San Jose, online allowed
- **ICDAM-2027:** London, online fee GBP 150
- **ICRCICN, ICESICSC:** hybrid in India
- **ICDF2C 2027:** New York, hybrid
- **Note:** no open venue is online-only; online still pays the full fee

ABROAD

- **Malta:** ICISSP, Valletta
- **Italy:** ICEIS and DATA, Rome
- **Spain:** ICEDEG (e-democracy), Tarragona
- **Sweden:** IFIP SEC, Linkoping
- **UK, USA, Japan:** ACNS, ISDFS, CSP
- **Not included:** travel and visa costs

RECOMMENDED SUBMISSION ORDER

One venue at a time: dual submission is not allowed

Step	Venue	Submit by	Decision	Why this order
1	ICISSP 2027 (Malta)	29 Oct 2026	4 Dec 2026	Best topical fit open now; EUR 640 plus travel
2a	INDIACom-2027 (Delhi)	7 Dec 2026	8 Feb 2027	Cheap India fallback if step 1 fails; IEEE not confirmed
2b	Confluence 2027 (Noida)	4 Dec 2026	25 Dec 2026	Alternative to 2a if you want a fast answer
3	ICEIS, IFIP SEC or ICDF2C	15-21 Dec 2026	mid-Feb 2027	Better-quality fallbacks; higher fees and travel
4	ISDFS 2027 (online ok)	31 Jan 2027	15 Feb 2027	IEEE-submitted, USD 500, can present online
5	ICEDEG or DATA/SECRYPT	Feb-Mar 2027	Apr-May 2027	Best audience; the highest cost

Before submitting: check the publisher's page, remove author names where double-blind, follow each venue's AI-disclosure rule, and recheck the deadline. Journals cost USD 2,000 to 3,000 in fees: only as a later extended version.

ROOMMATE LIST: REALITY CHECK

The venues are real; "easy" is not supported

HOLDS UP

- **ICRTAC:** real, VIT Chennai SCOPE, 9th edition 10-11 Dec 2026, but closed: the page shows no late route.
- **ICSCAN:** real; the 7th edition ran in June 2026.
- **i-PACT:** real, at VIT Vellore in Sep 2027, but it is a power-engineering conference.
- **E-Vote-ID:** real and the best topical fit.
- **DASFAA / ICDE demo tracks:** exist, but are competitive.

COULD NOT BE SUPPORTED

- **"75% acceptance":** no venue publishes it; ICRTAC 2024 took 36 of 315 papers, about 11%.
- **"Springer" for ICRTAC:** only the 2024 edition; 2026 says IEEE Xplore, subject to review.
- **ICSCAN / ICCCNT "IEEE":** not confirmed on the official sites.
- **ViTECoN:** no current call found.
- **"Fast to accept":** very short reviews are a warning sign, not a feature.

PUBLICATION PLAN

What we claim, how we choose, and what to submit first

OUR CLAIM

- **Yes:** a database-centric design that raises the cost of undetected tampering, with executable evidence and a stated threat model.
- **No:** parity with end-to-end verifiable voting systems.
- **Paper:** a 5-page IEEE-style paper and a 37-page report are ready.
- **Next:** tighten for the chosen venue's template and page limit.

CHOOSING A VENUE

- Check indexing on the publisher or Scopus page, not the conference page.
- Be wary of very short reviews, vague organisers, and fees without a proceedings publisher.
- Start with a good-fit venue, keep a backup, and treat stretch venues as upside.
- Follow each venue's policy on disclosing AI assistance in writing or coding.

PROJECT CONCLUSION · REVIEW 3

Thank You

Questions and discussion

Source code and documents
github.com/Tharakeshtj/polyvote-election-platform

Run it: `python -m uvicorn server:app --port 8000`
Demo copy: Sample PolyVote, with email verification on
Reports: Review 3 report (37 pages) and IEEE-style paper